

as fast as a bigger camera, although some models, like the Panasonic GF1, have this nailed.

As a new category, the EVIL is still relatively expensive, and you will pay as much for a body and lens as you would for a prosumer level DSLR. For many, even pros, the size difference alone is enough to justify this. For everyone else, you could wait until the likes of Canon and Nikon inevitably enter this sector. Then prices will start to fall, and things will get really interesting.

However, EVIL does have a few limitations. The lack of through-the-lens optical viewfinder (TTL OVF) is a defining feature of MILCs, and also found on compact cameras – a TTL optical viewfinder requires an optical path from lens to viewfinder, hence an SLR design or similar. If a TTL OVF is desired or required, dSLRs are the only viable option.

MILCs primarily use a rear LCD display for arm-level shooting, but some also feature an electronic viewfinder (EVF) for eye-level shooting, or an optical viewfinder that is not TTL (as in a rangefinder), which hence suffers from parallax, particularly at short distances.

Contrast-based AF has generally been slower than the phase-based AF systems found in dSLRs. The improvement in speed has been achieved by reducing the time taken for the contrast-detection autofocus system to begin operation after half-pressing the shutter button, doubling the sensor readout speed to 120 frames per second, and increasing the speed with which contrast detection routines operate. Although micros from Olympus and other manufacturers also have closed or leapfrogged this gap, there's still a gap in continuous autofocus accuracy and speed, and thus MILCs are still not as good at photographing moving objects, notably in sports, as dSLRs.

One advantage of contrast detection autofocus is that for still subjects, autofocus accuracy tends to be higher than with phase detect systems, as the camera is using the actual sensor output to determine focus. Therefore, CDAF systems are not prone to calibration issues such as front or back focus as can occur with phase detect systems.

All extant MILC or EVIL formats use a new lens mount, which is somewhat incompatible with existing lenses. This means both that existing lenses cannot be used without an adapter, and that relatively few native lenses exist for these cameras at the time of their introduction, as new lenses must be designed and manufactured for the new mount.

While they are interchangeable, compact dSLR lenses are not compatible with traditional dSLRs, even when the cameras come from the same